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Top Skills

Cross-team Collaboration
Cross-functional Collaborations
Cross-functional Team Leadership

Keith Schaeffer

Senior Sustaining Engineer with 18+ years in manufacturing. Skilled in process optimization, VA/VE, and leadership—driving savings, quality, and efficiency through cross-functional collaboration.
Dayton, Ohio, United States

Summary

Experienced Product Design Engineer with a demonstrated history of working in the consumer goods industry. Creo, Catia, SolidWorks, Root Cause Analysis, Continuous Improvement, RCQ and VAVE. Problem-solver with a high sense of urgency. Detail orientated. Able to manage multiple projects at the same time. Skills include project management, leadership, leading a cross-functional teams to solve issues through root cause analysis, product modification, destructive testing, certification testing, and ensuring the proper Engineering change procedures are followed and documented. Strong engineering professional with a AAS in Mechanical Design and a Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering. MIT Sloan-Skillsoft Percipio Manager Training. Skillsoft Percipio Project Manager Training.

Experience

Precision Impacts

Senior Design and Quality Engineer
August 2024 - October 2024 (3 months)
United States

Conducted First Article Inspection (FAI) for US Military M27 Mortar Fin production, identifying defects, performing root cause analysis, and driving corrective actions, leading to improved quality and a successful First Article Acceptance Testing (FAAT).

Optimized compressed air paintball tank production by adapting a new process to apply the resin and clear coat, reducing weight variations, defects, and waste, while greatly enhancing the product visual quality.

Led Lean process improvements by implementing communication boards, MS Team groups and Gemba walks enhancing real-time problem-solving, workflow efficiency, and defect reduction.

Safe Kids Worldwide

Volunteer: Child Passenger Safety Technician

November 2014 - July 2024 (9 years 9 months)

CPS technicians [...] use their considerable knowledge and expertise at a variety of community-based activities, such as child safety seat checks, where parents and caregivers receive education and hands-on assistance. (https://cert.safekids.org/become-tech)

GB / Goodbaby

Design Engineer, Child Safety Car Seats

October 2014 - July 2024 (9 years 10 months)

Miamisburg, Ohio

Goodbaby / Evenflo: Problem solver with a high sense of urgency, Project Management, RCQ/VAVE, 3D Modeling (CREO), Prototyping, Testing, Destructive Testing, Injection Mold Part Design, Injection Mold Tool Design, Mechanical Design Engineering, Design for Manufacturing and Assembly, Test Procedure Creation, Regulated Industry Experience, Risk Analysis

Led cross-functional VA/VE projects involving Engineering, Manufacturing, Quality, Procurement, Product Management, Marketing, and suppliers achieving $3.2M in total year-over-year cost savings through Design for Manufacturing (DFM), process optimization, engineering changes, and strategic commodity buys.

Identified $1.5M in cost savings by applying DFM/DFA principles while performing the roles of Project Manager, Design Engineer, and Test Engineer to streamline production and assembly for the resulting projects.

Managed 400+ engineering change activities, ensuring seamless design updates, maintaining documentation accuracy, coordinating cross-functional approvals, and driving successful implementation across all departments and suppliers.

Directed over 2,800 developmental and certification tests of federally regulated juvenile products across facilities in the U.S., Canada, and China, ensuring compliance with U.S. and Canadian standards, reviewed results, implemented corrective actions, and validated successful outcomes to meet stringent regulatory requirements

Mentored junior engineers, Engineering Co-Ops and cross-functional teams, providing technical guidance and process training to improve team performance.

Partnered with manufacturing teams to reduce part count on child restraint systems, leading to lower production costs, streamlined assembly, and improved performance.

Designed plastic injection-molded parts and production fixtures using Creo Parametric to support New Product Development (NPD) and Sustaining Engineering initiatives.

Neaton Auto Products, Mfg., Inc.
Design Engineer, Automotive Interior Design
February 2013 - October 2014 (1 year 9 months)
eaton, ohio

Work closely with Honda R&D and Honda's Assembly plants to design and modify interior parts, mainly plastic injection molded parts.

Use Catia V5 to create and modify 3D part models, and detailed part/assembly drawings for automotive parts and test fixtures/jig.

Work with Quality Control, Procurement, Manufacturing Engineering, and New Model Departments to provide properly leveled/matured parts for the customer.

Lead interdepartmental meetings, multi departmental meetings, meetings with suppliers, and with the customer to present design reviews, countermeasures, processes, testing, program schedules, part maturation schedules, and general program information.

Perform root cause analysis, conduct testing, collaborate with other departments to come up with the appropriate countermeasures to correct any issues with the parts, part drawings, 3D models, molds, and assembly processes.

Preform Value Added /Value Engineering cost saving activities.

Conduct training activities for new employees.

Honeywell ECC Maxon
Designer
April 2012 - January 2013 (10 months)
muncie, indiana area

Used Solid Edge to create 3D model parts and assembles. Created detailed drawings. Checked and modified existing drawings. Used J.D. Edwards software to create and maintain part numbers, bill of material, and configurations. Managed Product Service Requests (PSR's) by researching the problem, coming up with a solution, involving all shareholders to resolve the PSR from different departments to include marketing, sales, manufacturing, product engineering, manufacturing engineering, accounting, sourcing/procurement, and vendors/suppliers. Creating and leading meetings. Doing research to obsolete parts, processes, and product lines.

Wright State University
Full Time Student
August 2008 - November 2011 (3 years 4 months)

Sears Holdings Corporation
Auto Center Customer Service Representative
August 2008 - March 2009 (8 months)

Dayton Water Systems
Application Engineer
May 2002 - April 2008 (6 years)
dayton, ohio

Performed Application Engineering duties to include designing, quoting, site surveys, testing, and installing industrial/commercial water purification equipment to include water softeners, carbon filters, media filters, uv filters, reverse osmosis, and deionizes. Maintained Deionizer regeneration plant and neutralization system.

Education

Wright State University
Bachelor of Science (BS), Mechanical Engineering · (2007 - 2011)

Edison State Community College
Associate's of Applied Science- Mechanical Design, Mechanical Design · (1998 - 2002)

Edison State Community College

Associate's degree, Mechanical Design